

“THE BEST OF AMERICA DRIFTS TO PARIS.”

F. Scott Fitzgerald, American author



American dancer and singer Josephine Baker was described by writer Ernest Hemingway as “the most sensational woman anyone ever saw.”

PARIS REASSERTED ITS CLAIM as the world leader in taste and style with the **International Exhibition of Modern Industrial and Decorative Arts**. The exhibition gave a name—**Art Deco**—to the design trend toward angular shapes, abstract patterns, exuberant African, Aztec, and Egyptian motifs, and materials such as chromium and ivory. Art Deco soon set the style for everything from scent bottles and skyscrapers to ocean liners and movie theaters.

Less noticed at the time was a small exhibition of works in a Parisian gallery by artists calling themselves “**Surrealists**.” The group, which included the Catalan artist **Joan Miró** (1893–1983) and

Surrealist style

Harlequin's *Carnival* exemplifies the playful, anarchic style developed in the 1920s by Joan Miró, a Spanish Catalan artist living in Paris.



the American **Man Ray** (1890–1976), were dedicated to the exploration of dreams and unconscious impulses to subvert everyday reality. Over the following decade Surrealism was to become a major international art movement.

Man Ray was one of a **host of American expatriates** who **flocked to Paris** in the mid-1920s, lured by the vibrant cultural scene and the favorable exchange rate. American writers based in the city included Gertrude Stein (1874–1976), Ernest Hemingway (1899–1961), and F. Scott Fitzgerald (1896–1940), whose classic work *The Great Gatsby* was published in 1925. African-American erotic dancer **Josephine Baker** (1906–1975) became a star of Parisian nightlife, performing at the Theatre des Champs-Élysées. For their part, the French took an adoring interest in American jazz.

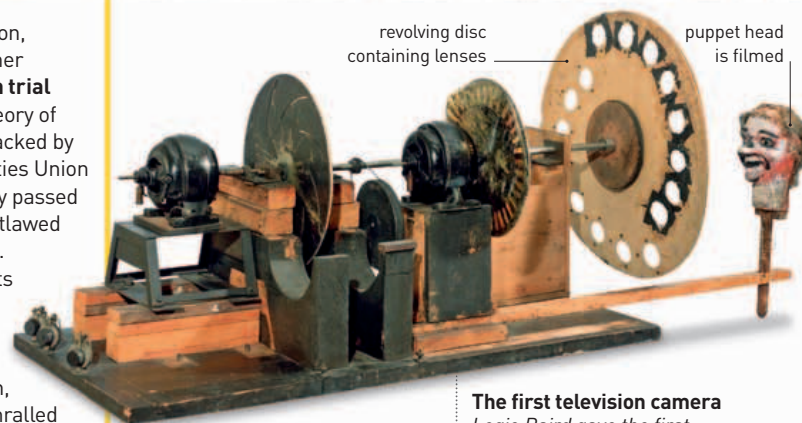
Back in the US, in Dayton, Tennessee, biology teacher **John Scopes** was put on trial for teaching Darwin's theory of evolution. Scopes was backed by the American Civil Liberties Union to test Tennessee's newly passed Butler Act, which had outlawed the teaching of evolution. Christian fundamentalists brought in former US Secretary of State William Jennings Bryan to act for the prosecution, and after a trial that enthralled America, Scopes was **found guilty**, although the verdict was later quashed.

The general world **political and economic outlook** was better than at any time since World War I. In April, Britain's Chancellor of the Exchequer, Winston Churchill, returned his country's currency to the prewar **Gold Standard**. This set the value of sterling artificially high, creating problems for British exporters, but it was an important gesture toward the restoration of international financial stability.

In December, the **Locarno Pact** was signed. This was a series of treaties designed to restore normal peacetime relations between Germany and the victor states of World War I. The agreement depended on the relationship established between the German and French foreign ministers, Gustav Stresemann and Aristide Briand, and opened the way for Germany's admission to the League of Nations in 1926.



Reza Khan Pahlavi on his throne after being appointed shah of Iran. His aim was to modernize his country along secular Western lines.



The first television camera
Logie Baird gave the first demonstration of television using a mechanical system with a spinning disk as the scanner.

IN JANUARY 1926, SCOTTISH ENGINEER JOHN LOGIE BAIRD (1888–1946) made the **first demonstration of a television transmission** in a loft in London's Soho district. Fifty members of the Royal Institution saw the indistinct, but recognizable moving image of a face.

In May, Britain experienced its only **General Strike**. This nationwide industrial stoppage, in support of coal miners, paralyzed transportation networks and docks, and closed down factories and newspapers. The government responded by mobilizing troops and recruiting volunteers to maintain essential services. After nine days the unions backed down and ordered a return to work.

In **Poland**, the nation's military hero **Marshal Jozef Pilsudski** (1867–1935) led a **coup d'état** in May, in reaction against the unstable parliamentary government. Pilsudski declined the presidency, but effectively took dictatorial powers.

In Iran, another military strongman, **Reza Khan Pahlavi** (1878–1944), **established a new dynasty** by crowning himself as shah on April 25; his intention was to modernize his country. The Pahlavi dynasty he founded ruled in Iran until the 1970s.

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MILLION
THE NUMBER OF WORKING DAYS LOST TO STRIKES IN THE UK IN 1926

January 3 Benito Mussolini cracks down on opposition in Italy, taking dictatorial powers

April 3 Britain returns to Gold Standard

March 21 Chinese nationalist leader Sun Yat-sen dies; he is succeeded by Chiang Kai-shek

April 25 World War I hero Paul von Hindenburg elected German president

April 10 F. Scott Fitzgerald's novel *The Great Gatsby* published

July 18 Adolf Hitler publishes *Mein Kampf*

May 31 Decorative arts (Art Deco) exhibition opens in Paris

August 2 French troops fight rebels in Syria at **Battle of al-Mazraa**

July 21 In US, teacher John Scopes found guilty of teaching Darwin's Theory of Evolution

September 8 Spanish troops stage amphibious landings at Alhucemas Bay, Morocco, to defeat Rif rebellion

November 13 First surrealist exhibition opens in Paris

December 1 Locarno Pact normalizes relations between Germany and other European states

January 26 Logie Baird demonstrates television in London

April 25 Reza Khan Pahlavi crowns himself ruler of Iran

May 3 General strike begins in Britain in support of striking coal miners

May 14 Josef Pilsudski seizes power in Poland in military coup

May 28 Coup establishes a military dictatorship in Portugal

October 19 Stalin has his rivals Trotsky and Zinoviev expelled from the Soviet Politburo

September 8 Germany admitted to League of Nations

October 19–November 18 Imperial Conference in London recognizes Dominions as equal in status to Britain